

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1999-08-24

To all National Spiritual Assemblies dear bahá'ís

The historic associations of the cause of bahá'u'lláh with Turkey, a land held sacred in the hearts of bahá'ís, make of the disaster wreaked by the recent earthquake an event of inexpressible sorrow for the bahá'í world.

while we are relieved to have received reports that the lives of our coreligionists were spared, we grieve with all those who have suffered incalculable loss both from the deaths in the thousands of their fellow-citizens and from

1996–2000 • The Four Year Plan 689 the extensive destruction of property. in addition to our fervent prayers in the holy Shrines for the bereaved and distressed, we have arranged for a financial contribution to be made towards relief efforts. moreover, the principal representative of the bahá'í international community at the united Nations has been asked to convey to the president of Turkey heartfelt condolences on behalf of our world community.

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]